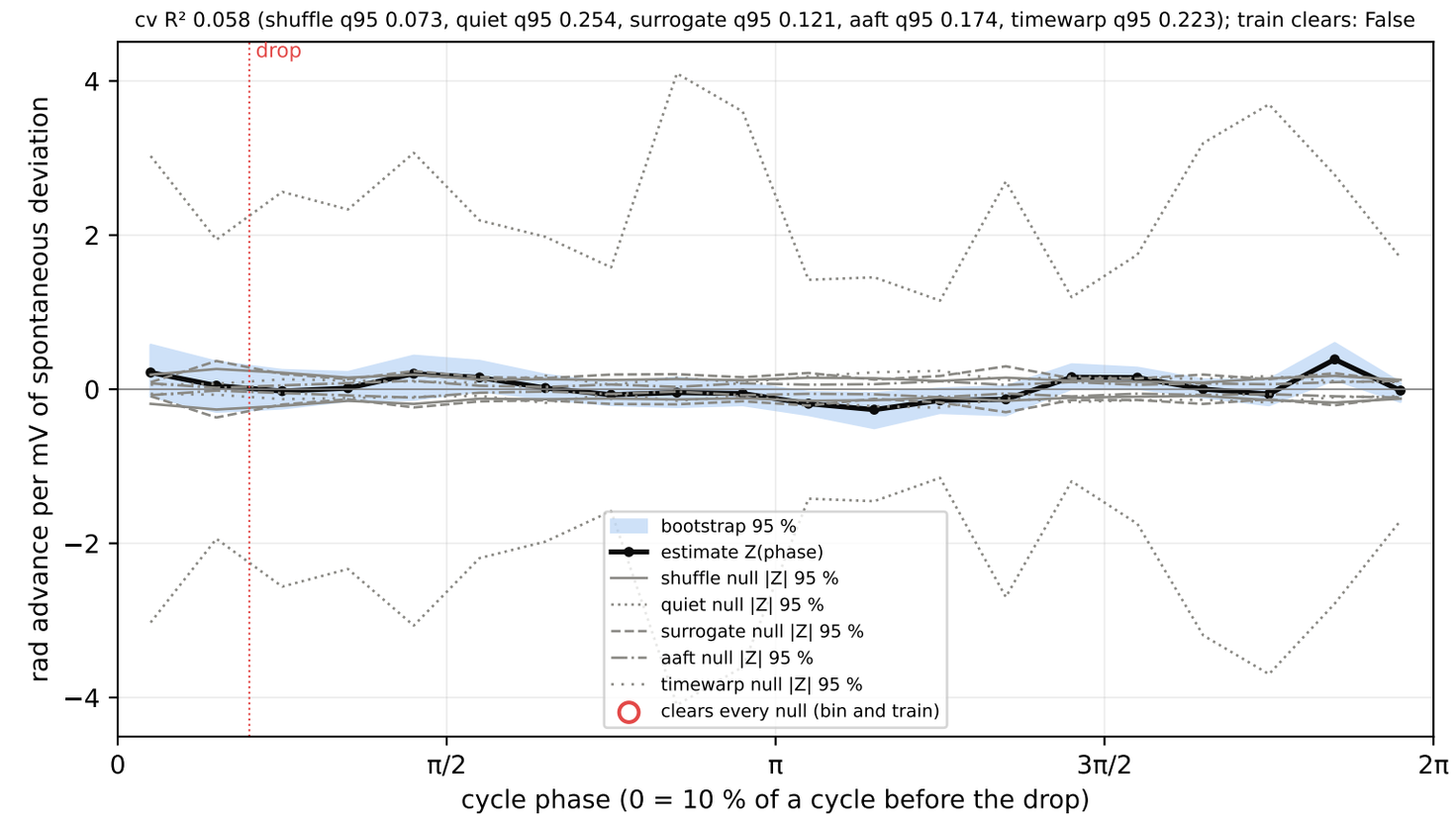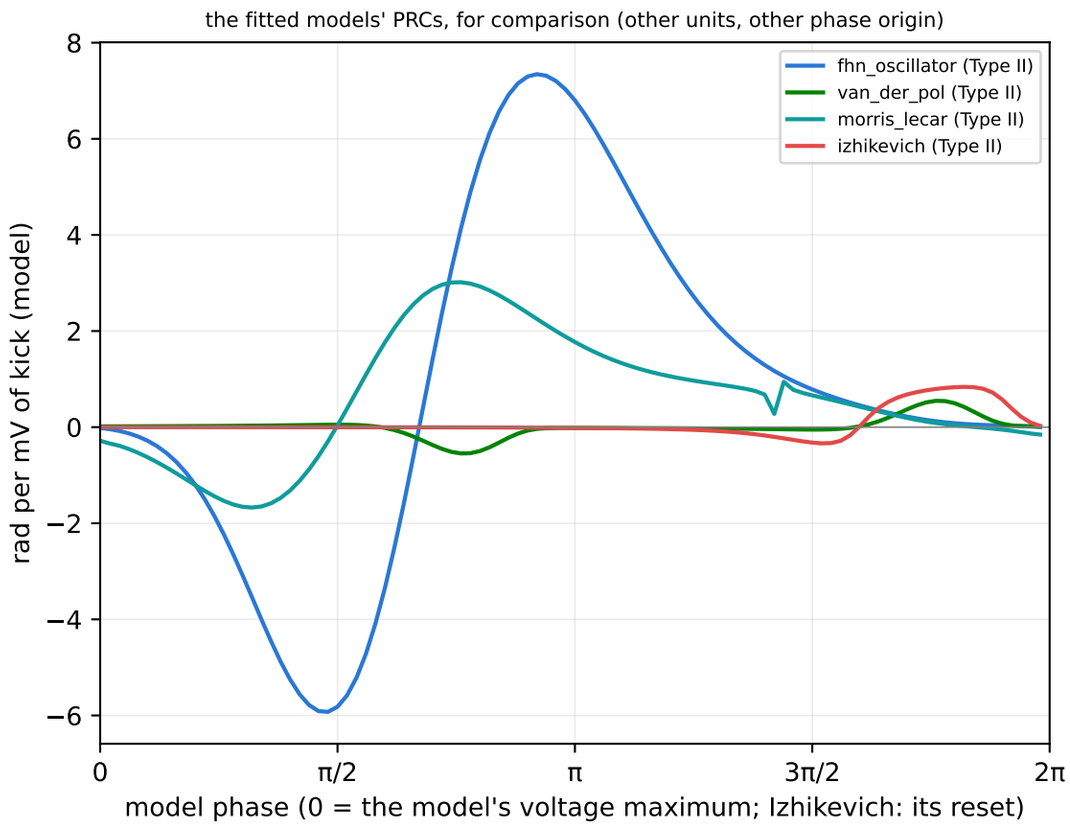rec3_490_540h_ext: spontaneous phase-timing estimate: a CORRELATION between the signal's own deviations and the next drop's timing, not a PRC